independent. I will carry on the Sangh work honestly, selflessly and with all my physical, mental and monetary strength and will stick to this resolve throughout my life.

This original pledge was instituted as a Sangh tradition by Dr Hedgewar as part of the first RSS initiation ceremony with a select group of ninety-nine Sangh members in 1928.[65] The line in the pledge on making the Hindu Rashtra 'independent' was changed after Independence to '*Hindu Rashtra ki sarvangin unnati*' (all-round development of the Hindu Rashtra).[66] I do not know what the boys in the library thought about the Sangh or the pledge. They were studying so hard, I did not have the heart to disturb them any further. But they would have seen the images on the wall just a few feet away and would likely have been aware of the discourse.

Figure 14.5: Education Is a Key Part of Sangh Parivar Work: Snapshots from Deendayal Upadhyaya Shodh Pustakalaya